

Education Indicator

PROVIDER

Māori Parent Representation on School Boards

Proportional Māori parent representation on school boards has ranged between 38% and 42% since 2013.

Indicator Description

The percentage of schools with proportional Māori parent representation on the school board as at 1 December.

Why this is important

Active participation by whānau Māori in planning, development and delivery of education services will help to ensure that those services are appropriate and effective for ākonga Māori. Māori parent representation on school boards is one key mechanism for participation.

The Government is committed to strengthening schools/kura boards by providing support and encouraging them to be more representative of the communities they serve. The Ministry is now making progress around board capability, including work to make boards more representative of their communities.

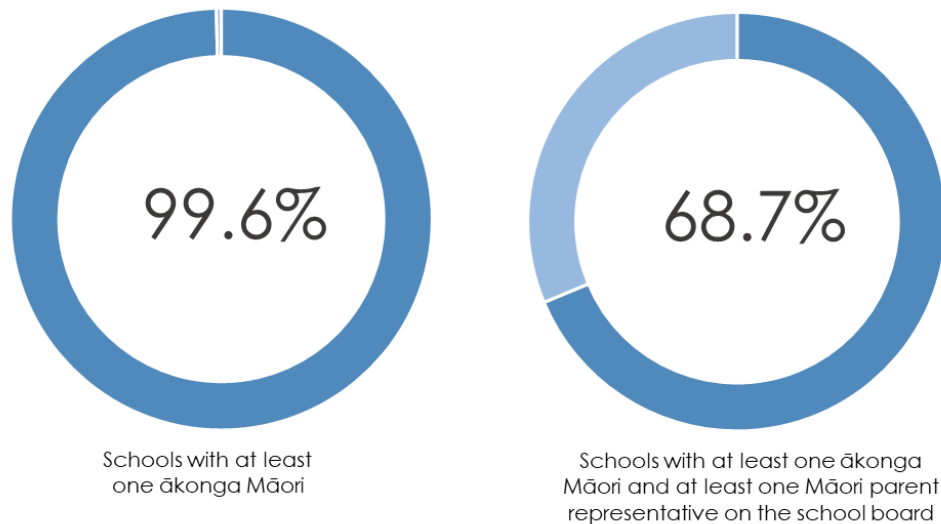
School boards comprise the principal, parent representatives, a staff representative and may also include other members. Boards of state and state-integrated schools must hold elections for parent representatives every three years. A board may also decide to adopt a mid-term election cycle where half of its parent representatives are elected at a mid-term election (18 months after the triennial election) and the remainder are elected at the triennial election.

Triennial elections have been held every three years since 1998, with the most recent elections held in 2022. A by-election can occur at any stage in the election cycle if an elected parent representative leaves the board and creates a vacancy. Although the major changes in board membership occur in triennial election years, there is still some fluctuation in intervening years due to by-elections and mid-term elections.

How are we going

In 2022, 99.6% of schools¹ (2,377 schools) had at least one ākonga Māori (Figure 1). Of all the schools with at least one ākonga Māori, 68.7% (1,633 schools) had at least one Māori parent representative on the school board.

Figure 1: In 2022, almost all schools had at least one ākonga Māori, and more than two-thirds of the schools with at least one ākonga Māori had at least one Māori parent representative on the school board



Proportional Representation

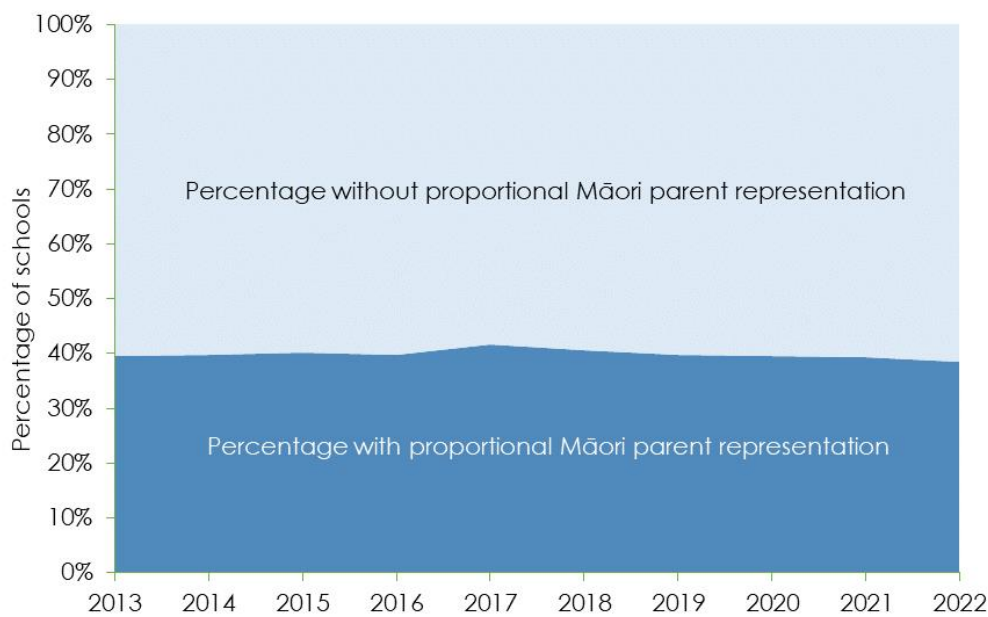
In 2022 there were 2,210 schools (92.6%) with enough ākonga Māori to expect at least one Māori parent representative on the school board. This is based both on the number of ākonga Māori and the number of positions on the board.

Representation on a school board is “proportional” when the proportion of board seats held by Māori parent representatives is at least equivalent to the proportion of ākonga Māori in the school. This is restricted to those schools with enough ākonga Māori to expect at least one Māori parent representative on the board.

The percentage of schools with proportional Māori parent representation on the school board is 38.4% in 2022. The proportional Māori parent representation on school boards has ranged between 38%-42% during the years 2013 to 2022 (Figure 2).

¹ Schools with available parent school board information.

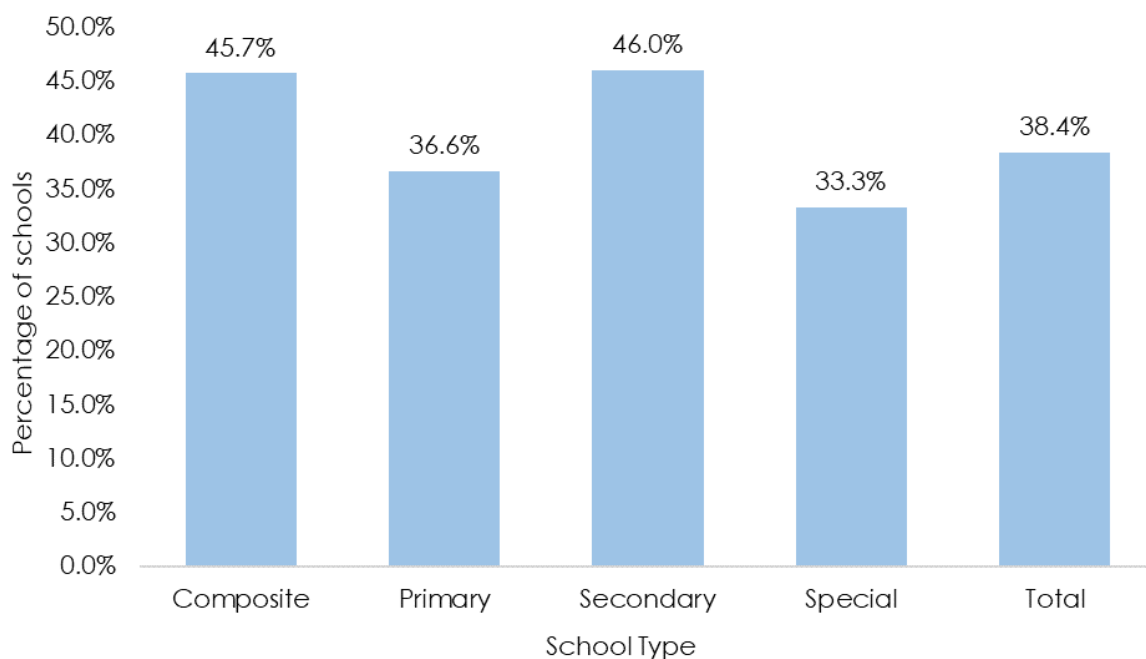
Figure 2: The percentage of schools with proportional Māori parent representation has changed little since 2013



School Type

In 2022, secondary schools had the highest proportional Māori parent representation on the board (46.0%). Composite schools had the second highest proportional Māori parent representation on the board (45.7%). Representation was lower in primary (36.6%) and special schools (33.3%) (Figure 3).

Figure 3: Secondary and composite schools had the highest percentage of proportional Māori representation in 2022



Where to Find Out More

To obtain further statistics on school boards try:

- [School boards](#)
- [Pacific parent representation on school boards.](#)

References

- [Education and Training Act 2020](#)
- [Your school board – Parents.education.govt.nz – Practical information about education for parents and carers](#)

